Qixuan(Talia) Chen

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Education

University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX
Ph.D. in Computer Science — *Sep. 2025 – Present*
- GPA: 3.84/4.0
- Advisor: Vijay Chidambaram

Boston University — Boston, MA
Bachelor of Arts & Master of Science in Computer Science — *Sep 2021 – May 2025*
- GPA: 3.85/4.0
- Advisor: Vasiliki (Vasia) Kalavri

Research Interests

LLM/Agentic AI Systems, ML Systems, Storage Systems

Publications

- **Qixuan Chen**, Yuhang Song, Melissa Martinez, Vasiliki Kalavri. **RingSampler: GNN Sampling on Large-Scale Graphs with io_uring**. *Proceedings of the 17th ACM Workshop on Hot Topics in Storage and File Systems (HotStorage)*, pages 52–60. (HotStorage '25)

Research Experience

Research Assistant — Aug 2025 - Present
UT Systems and Storage Lab — *Austin, TX*
- Advisor: Vijay Chidambaram
- Building System to optimize agentic workflows for batched query processing, providing adaptive execution and improving resource utilization
- Developing distributed vector databases with CXL to handle large-scale datasets and support high-demand LLMs

Research Assistant — Sep 2023 – Jul 2025
Boston University CASP Lab — *Boston, MA*
- Advisor: Vasiliki Kalavri
- Scale Graph Neural Network sampling on large-than-memory graphs using io_uring

Industry Experience

Research Intern — May 2026 – Aug 2026
IBM — *San Jose, CA*
- Contributed to Certus, an open-sourced AI-native storage system for KV-cache management
- Characterized KV-cache access patterns across diverse LLM serving workloads and proposed a workload-aware storage architecture for KV-cache management

Software Engineer Intern — Sep 2022 – May 2025
BU Spark! at Boston University — *Boston, MA*
- Developed an interactive data management portal for Harvard University Herbaria using PHP, integrating a text recognition ML model to streamline data entry and significantly enhance data management efficiency

Frontend Engineer — Nov 2022 – Aug 2023
SunnySide — *Remote*
- Led React Native development for a mental health app, designing key screens from Figma prototypes and optimizing journal storage using WebView with the Quill library

Teaching Experience

- **CS 329E Elements of Data Visualization**: Teaching Assistant (UT Austin, Fall 2026)
- **CS 380D Distributed System**: Teaching Assistant (UT Austin, Spring 2026)
- **CS 395T Distributed System-WB**: Teaching Assistant (UT Austin, Fall 2025)

Awards

McKinley Strahan Graduate Fellowship (UT Austin) Jan 2026
Finalist, Student Research Competition (SOSP 2024) Nov 2024
Student Scholarship (SOSP 2024) Oct 2024
UROP Research Award (Boston University) Apr 2024

Extracurricular Activities

Co-director Sep 2022 – May 2024
BU Machine Intelligence Community(BUMIC) *Boston, MA*

- Organized weekly cooperative learning workshops and public speaking events on Machine Learning to engage students and foster community growth

AI Fellow Oct 2024
Break Through Tech *Boston, MA*

- Mentored underrepresented students interested in ML, sharing personal experience and providing career advice

Service

- **Artifact Evaluation Committee**: OSDI'25
- **Volunteer**: SOSP'24